30 STEPS / 5 BLOCKS / ONE PILOT

Replace tool sprawl with one agent stack.

You pay for many tools. Each one holds a little of your work. None of them talk to each other. This guide moves your work into one agent stack. Do one block a day.

Start with one job.

Keep the tools that earn their place. Test one repeatable job before you move more work into the stack.

01 / AUDIT

Find overlap and choose a pilot.

02 / CORE

Write rules and test one result.

03 / MEMORY + TASKS

Keep notes and next steps in one place.

04 / PARALLEL AGENTS

Give each project a clear owner.

05 / DISTRIBUTION

Approve drafts and review the pilot.

For solo operators and small service businesses. Use your own test data. Keep client and workplace data out of the pilot.

DAYS 1 + 2 / AUDIT AND CORE

01 Audit

- [ ] 01 List every paid tool. Write the monthly cost next to each. Use your card statements, not memory.
- [ ] 02 Mark each tool: used weekly, used monthly, unused. Cancel nothing yet.
- [ ] 03 For each weekly tool, write the one job you hire it for. One sentence.
- [ ] 04 Circle jobs that move data between tools. Pick a repeatable job with a result you can check.
- [ ] 05 Circle jobs that need your judgment. Keep these manual for now.
- [ ] 06 Pick ONE circled job. This is your pilot. Write it at the top of a new page.

02 Core

- [ ] 07 Install Claude Code. Open it in an empty folder.
- [ ] 08 Write a short CLAUDE.md in that folder. Put in: who you are, what you do, 5 rules for how the agent works with you.
- [ ] 09 Add one rule: "Ask before sending, deleting or paying. Follow the agreed scope for all other work."
- [ ] 10 Give the agent your pilot job from step 6. Let it do the read-only part first.
- [ ] 11 Read what it did. Fix the instructions, not the output. Repeat until the read-only part is right.
- [ ] 12 Approve the write part for one real item. Check the result yourself.

DAYS 3 + 4 / CONTEXT AND OWNERSHIP

03 Memory and tasks

- ☐ 13 Pick one place for notes. I use Notion. Any single place works. The rule is one place.
- ☐ 14 Make three pages: Projects, Decisions, Tool notes.
- ☐ 15 Tell the agent to read Tool notes before it touches any tool.
- ☐ 16 Pick one task list. Mine is Todoist. Every job becomes a task with a description the agent can act on.
- ☐ 17 Add a shared memory the agent can search. Mine is Mem0. Store facts and results, not chat.
- ☐ 18 Write the rule: "After each job, save a result and record the next step within the agreed scope."
- ☐ 19 Test it. Start a fresh session. Ask "what did we do on the pilot?" It should answer from memory, not guess.

04 Parallel agents

- ☐ 20 Install a terminal that splits panes. I use cmux. tmux also works.
- ☐ 21 Give each project its own pane and its own CLAUDE.md.
- ☐ 22 Send lookups and bulk reading to sub-agents. Keep the main session for decisions and approvals.
- ☐ 23 Never let two agents edit the same file. One owner per file.
- ☐ 24 End each session with "save state": results to memory, next step to the task list.

DAY 5 / DISTRIBUTION AND REVIEW

05 Distribution

- ☐ 25 Connect your tools to the agent through MCP servers. Add one at a time. Test each with a read-only call.
- ☐ 26 Pick one posting rail for social. Zernio is the example in this stack. Check its current terms before connecting.
- ☐ 27 Have the agent draft posts into a queue. Approve each final post and destination before scheduling.
- ☐ 28 Draft a comment keyword for one post. Plan how replies will reach a free resource.
- ☐ 29 Schedule your pilot only after a manual test passes. Keep a run log and a way to stop it.
- ☐ 30 Re-run the audit from step 1. Export needed data before you approve cancelling an unused tool. Record any actual saving.

Stack example [prior]

Claude Code, cmux, Notion, Todoist, Mem0 and Zernio. Swap a tool for one you already use. Keep the structure.

Your pilot record

Job tested: _____

Result checked: _____

Tool retained or removed: _____

Next step: _____

Adapted from the existing 8 November draft. The stack example is prior build context, not a new product test. Timings and savings depend on your pilot. Tool names are trademarks of their owners.